

In-text citations and a reference list that match — both directions

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

Harvard is an author-date referencing style in which sources are cited in the text by author surname and year, and listed in full alphabetically at the end. EUBS requires Harvard throughout the dissertation. Correct referencing does two jobs: it credits the ideas of others (avoiding plagiarism) and it lets a reader locate every source. The in-text citations and the reference list must correspond exactly — every citation has an entry, and every entry is cited (Pears and Shields, 2019).

IN-TEXT CITATION

Author surname and year in brackets: (Porter, 1985). Direct quotation adds a page number: (Porter, 1985, p. 12). Two authors: (Kim and Mauborgne, 2005). Three or more: (Teece et al., 1997). Citing a source within a source: (Ansoff, 1965, cited in Johnson et al., 2020).

REFERENCE LIST ENTRY

Book: Author, Initial. (Year) Title. Edition. Place: Publisher. Journal: Author (Year) 'Article title', Journal, vol(issue), pp. Web: Author/Org (Year) Title. Available at: URL (Accessed: date). Alphabetical by first author; no numbering.

The two-way match is what markers check. Run a bidirectional audit before submission: every in-text citation must appear in the reference list, and every list entry must be cited at least once in the text. Orphan citations and uncited entries are among the most common — and most avoidable — written-communication deductions.

Source	Harvard reference pattern
Book	Surname, I. (Year) <i>Title</i> . Edn. Place: Publisher.
Journal	Surname, I. (Year) 'Title', <i>Journal</i> , vol(issue), pp.
Chapter	Surname, I. (Year) 'Chapter', in Ed. (ed.) <i>Book</i> . Place: Pub.
Website	Org (Year) <i>Title</i> . Available at: URL (Accessed: date).
Report	Org (Year) <i>Title</i> . Place: Publisher.

BE CONSISTENT

Pick one Harvard variant and apply it identically throughout. Mixed punctuation and formats read as carelessness and lose marks.

PEER-REVIEWED FIRST

Prioritise journal articles and academic books over blogs and non-reviewed web pages. Source quality is graded, not just format.

AUDIT BOTH WAYS

Check citations-to-list and list-to-citations. This is where the AI Annex screenshots also protect you against hallucinated entries.

Common pitfalls. (1) In-text citations missing from the list (or vice versa). (2) Mixed referencing styles. (3) Missing page numbers on direct quotes. (4) Over-reliance on non-peer-reviewed web sources. (5) Fabricated or unverified references — verify every one against the original.

REFERENCES

Pears, R. and Shields, G. (2019) *Cite Them Right: The Essential Referencing Guide*. 11th edn. London: Red Globe Press. · Follow the EUBS Harvard specification in the dissertation guidelines.